



SUPER TEST

CONDITIONALS

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1. Should the intermittent rains continue to deluge the region, the municipal corporation _____ the evacuation protocol immediately.

A. initiates

B. would initiate

C. will initiate

D. initiated

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A. initiates

B. would initiate

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D. initiated

1. Should (If) the intermittent rains **continue** to deluge the region, the municipal corporation _____ the evacuation protocol immediately.

A. initiates

B. would initiate

C. will initiate

D. Initiated

Explanation: This is a First Conditional in an inverted form. The use of "Should" at the beginning replaces "If" (If the rains continue...). It refers to a possible future event. The result clause requires the future simple (will initiate).

2. If thermodynamic laws _____ universal, energy could be created or destroyed at whim.

- A. are not
- B. were not
- C. had not been
- D. would not be

2. If thermodynamic laws _____ universal, energy could be created or destroyed at whim.

A. are not

B. were not

C. had not been

D. would not be

2. If thermodynamic laws _____ universal, energy **could be created** or destroyed at whim.

A. are not

B. were not

C. had not been

D. would not be

Explanation: This is a Second Conditional (Hypothetical Present). We use "were" for all subjects (even "laws," though "are" is factually true, the "If" makes it a hypothetical contrary to fact).

Example: If I were a bird (but I am not), I would fly.

3. If I _____ so much debt, I would have liquidated my assets and moved to Switzerland months ago.

- A. hadn't had
- B. didn't have
- C. am not having
- D. weren't to have

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A. hadn't had

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C. am not having

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3. If I _____ so much debt, I **would have** liquidated my assets and moved to Switzerland months ago.

A. hadn't had

B. didn't have

C. am not having

D. weren't to have

Explanation: **Mixed (Type 2 + 3)**. Having debt is an ongoing situation (Second Conditional), which prevented a past action (moving).

4. Had the meticulous auditor scrutinized the ledgers earlier, the embezzlement _____ detected before the fiscal year-end.

- A. would be
- B. will have been
- C. would have been
- D. had been

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- B. will have been
- C. would have been
- D. had been

4. **Had** the meticulous auditor **scrutinised** the ledgers earlier, the embezzlement _____ detected before the fiscal year-end.

- A. would be
- B. will have been
- C. would have been**
- D. had been

Explanation: This is an inverted Third Conditional. "Had the auditor scrutinised" is equivalent to "If the auditor had scrutinised." It refers to a past impossibility. The result must be **would have + past participle**.

5. Had the fire department not arrived so promptly, the entire block _____ in ruins right now.

- A. would have been
- B. would be
- C. will be
- D. were

5. Had the fire department not arrived so promptly, the entire block _____ in ruins right now.

A. would have been

B. would be

C. will be

D. were

5. **Had** the fire department not **arrived** so promptly, the entire block _____ in ruins right **now**.

A. would have been

B. would be

C. will be

D. were

Explanation: Mixed (Type 3 + 2). Past action (arrival) prevents a Present state (ruins).

6. If he _____ such an abrasive personality, his colleagues would have supported his promotion last year.

- A. hadn't had
- B. didn't have
- C. hasn't
- D. wouldn't have

6. If he _____ such an abrasive personality, his colleagues would have supported his promotion last year.

A. hadn't had

B. didn't have

C. hasn't

D. wouldn't have

6. If he _____ such an abrasive personality, his colleagues **would have** supported his promotion last year.

A. hadn't had

B. didn't have

C. hasn't

D. wouldn't have

Explanation: Mixed (Type 2 + 3). He always has an abrasive personality (state), which affected a past event (promotion).

7. When the temperature of an alloy _____ its critical threshold, the molecular structure undergoes a phase transition.

- A. reached
- B. will reach
- C. would reaches
- D. reaches

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- B. will reach
- C. would reaches
- D. reaches

7. When the temperature of an alloy _____ its critical threshold, the molecular structure **undergoes** a phase transition.

- A. reached
- B. will reach
- C. would reaches
- D. reaches**

Explanation: This is a Zero Conditional. It expresses a scientific fact or general truth. Both clauses use the Simple Present.

8. Were the CEO _____ relinquish his post today, the board of directors would face an unprecedented leadership vacuum.

A. to be

B. has

C. to

D. had

8. Were the CEO _____ relinquish his post today, the board of directors would face an unprecedented leadership vacuum.

A. to be

B. has

C. to

D. had

8. **Were** the CEO _____ **relinquish** his post today, the board of directors would face an unprecedented leadership vacuum.

A. to be

B. has

C. to

D. had

Explanation: This is a Second Conditional Inversion. The structure "Were + Subject + to-infinitive" is used for remote future possibilities. "Were the CEO to relinquish" means "If the CEO relinquished."

9. If the reservoir had not breached its banks last spring, the valley _____ still fertile today.

- A. would be
- B. would have been
- C. will be
- D. had been

9. If the reservoir had not breached its banks last spring, the valley _____ still fertile today.

A. would be

B. would have been

C. will be

D. had been

9. If the reservoir **had not breached** its banks last spring, the valley _____ still fertile **today**.

A. **would be**

B. would have been

C. will be

D. had been

Explanation:

Mixed (Type 3 + 2). Past event (breaching) leads to the present state (fertility).

10. If the witness had not faltered during the cross-examination, the defendant _____ acquitted by the jury last week.

- A. would be
- B. would have been
- C. will be
- D. had been

10. If the witness had not faltered during the cross-examination, the defendant _____ acquitted by the jury last week.

A. would be

B. would have been

C. will be

D. had been

10. If the witness **had** not **faltered** during the cross-examination, the defendant _____ acquitted by the jury last week.

A. would be

B. would have been

C. will be

D. had been

Explanation:

Third Conditional. Past cause (faltering) led to a past result (not being acquitted). Tense: If + past perfect, would have + V3.

10. If the witness **had** not **faltered** during the cross-examination, the defendant _____ acquitted by the jury last week.

A. would be

B. would have been

C. will be

D. had been

Explanation:

Third Conditional. Past cause (faltering) led to a past result (not being acquitted). Tense: If + past perfect, would have + V3.

11. Were you more observant, you _____ the subtle discrepancies in the report during the morning briefing.

- A. would notice
- B. would have noticed
- C. had noticed
- D. will have noticed

11. Were you more observant, you _____ the subtle discrepancies in the report during the morning briefing.

A. would notice

B. would have noticed

C. had noticed

D. will have noticed

11. **Were** you more observant, you _____ the subtle discrepancies in the report during the morning briefing.

A. would notice

B. would have noticed

C. had noticed

D. will have noticed

Explanation:

Mixed (Type 2 + 3). General state (not observant) caused a past failure to notice something.

12. If the patient had taken the full course of antibiotics, he _____ in such a critical condition now.

A. wouldn't have been

B. won't be

C. isn't

D. wouldn't be

12. If the patient had taken the full course of antibiotics, he _____ in such a critical condition now.

A. wouldn't have been

B. won't be

C. isn't

D. wouldn't be

12. If the patient **had taken** the full course of antibiotics, he _____ in such a critical condition **now**.

A. wouldn't have been

B. won't be

C. isn't

D. wouldn't be

Explanation:

Mixed (Type 3 + 2). Past failure to take medicine leads to a Present critical state.

13. Phosphorus _____ spontaneously if it is exposed to atmospheric oxygen at room temperature.

- A. ignited
- B. will ignite
- C. ignites
- D. would ignite

13. Phosphorus _____ spontaneously if it is exposed to atmospheric oxygen at room temperature.

- A. ignited
- B. will ignite
- C. ignites
- D. would ignite

14. If the scientist _____ so renowned in her field, she wouldn't have been invited to keynote the symposium last month.

- A. hadn't been
- B. isn't
- C. were not
- D. would not be

14. If the scientist _____ so renowned in her field, she wouldn't have been invited to keynote the symposium last month.

A. hadn't been

B. isn't

C. were not

D. would not be

14. If the scientist _____ so renowned in her field, she wouldn't have been invited to keynote the symposium last month.

A. hadn't been

B. isn't

C. were not

D. would not be

Explanation:

Mixed Conditional (Type 2 + 3). Her being renowned is a continuous state (Second Conditional). The invitation happened in the past (Third Conditional).

15. Provided the diplomatic envoy _____ the treaty by midnight, the impending trade sanctions will be suspended.

- A. signs
- B. signed
- C. would sign
- D. had signed

15. Provided (**If**) the diplomatic envoy _____ the treaty by midnight, the impending trade sanctions **will be suspended**.

A. **signs**

B. signed

C. would sign

D. had signed

Explanation:

First Conditional. "Provided" acts as the conditional conjunction. Future real possibility: If + Present Simple, will + V1.).

16. Had the diplomat not been a polyglot, he _____
unable to negotiate the ceasefire last night.

- A. would be
- B. would have been
- C. will be
- D. was

16. Had the diplomat not been a polyglot, he _____
unable to negotiate the ceasefire last night.

A. would be

B. would have been

C. will be

D. was

16. **Had** the diplomat not **been** a polyglot, he _____
unable to negotiate the ceasefire **last night**.

A. would be

B. would have been

C. will be

D. was

Explanation:

This is actually a standard Third Conditional Inversion, but often confused with Mixed. Since both the cause and result are in the past, Type 3 is used. However, if the result were "he would be struggling **now**", it would be mixed.

Polyglot (adjective): Speaking or using several different languages:
She was reading a polyglot bible, with the text in English, Latin and Greek.

17. If I were not so punctilious about my work, I
_____ the deadline yesterday.

- A. would miss
- B. would have missed
- C. had missed
- D. will have missed

17. If I were not so punctilious about my work, I
_____ the deadline yesterday.

- A. would miss
- B. would have missed
- C. had missed
- D. will have missed

17. If I **were** not so punctilious about my work, I _____ the deadline yesterday.

- A. would miss
- B. would have missed**
- C. had missed
- D. will have missed

Explanation:

Mixed Conditional (Type 2 + 3). A permanent state/trait (being punctilious) influenced a past event (missing the deadline).

punctilious

(very careful to behave correctly or to give attention to details)

He was always punctilious in his manners.

18. If I _____ in your shoes, I would have de-escalated the confrontation before it turned physical.

A. am

B. was

C. were

D. had been

18. If I _____ in your shoes, I **would have** de-escalated the confrontation before it turned physical.

A. am

B. was

C. were

D. had been

Explanation:

Though "were" is tempting, the result clause "would have de-escalated" (Past) indicates a Third Conditional. Therefore, we need the Past Perfect "had been" to match the past hypothetical.

19. Unless the conglomerate _____ its carbon footprint, it will face heavy penalties from the environmental regulatory body.

- A. reduces
- B. does not reduce
- C. will reduce
- D. reduced

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A. reduces

B. does not reduce

C. will reduce

D. reduced

19. Unless the conglomerate _____ its carbon footprint, it will face heavy penalties from the environmental regulatory body.

A. reduces

B. does not reduce

C. will reduce

D. reduced

Explanation:

First Conditional with "Unless" (meaning "If...not"). We do not use "not" after "unless" as it is already negative.

19. Unless the conglomerate _____ its carbon footprint, it will face heavy penalties from the environmental regulatory body.

Conglomerate (noun)

A **company** that owns several smaller businesses whose products or services are usually very different:

a financial/industrial conglomerate

Conglomerate (noun) [C or U]

a **rock** that consists of small, rounded stones that are held together by clay and sand

20. If the architect had utilised more resilient materials during construction, the edifice _____ so precarious today.

- A. would not have been
- B. will not be
- C. would not be
- D. is not

20. If the architect had utilised more resilient materials during construction, the edifice _____ so precarious today.

A. would not have been

B. will not be

C. would not be

D. is not

20. If the architect **had utilised** more resilient materials during construction, the edifice _____ so precarious **today**.

A. would not have been

B. will not be

C. would not be

D. is not

Explanation: Mixed Conditional (Type 3 + 2). Past Action (didn't use materials) has a Present Result (building is currently shaky). Structure: If + Past Perfect, would + V1.

21. Were the judicial committee _____ find any evidence of malfeasance, the minister's resignation would be non-negotiable.

A. has

B. to

C. had

D. would

E. Correct Answer: B Explanation: This is a formal Inverted Second Conditional. The structure Were + Subject + to-infinitive is used to discuss a remote or unlikely future possibility. It is the scholarly equivalent of "If the committee found..." Simple Example: Were he to fail (If he failed), he would try again.

21. Were the judicial committee _____ find any evidence of malfeasance, the minister's resignation would be non-negotiable.

A. has

B. to

C. had

D. would

21. **Were** the judicial committee ____ **to** ____ **find** any evidence of malfeasance, the minister's resignation **would be** non-negotiable.

A. has

B. to

C. had

D. Would

Explanation: This is a formal Inverted Second Conditional (Hypothetical Present/Future). The structure **Were + Subject + to-infinitive** is used to discuss a remote or unlikely future possibility. It is the scholarly equivalent of **"If the committee found..."**

Simple Example: *Were he to fail (If he failed), he would try again.*

22. Should the fiscal deficit _____ the projected ceiling, the central bank will be compelled to hike interest rates.

- A. exceeds
- B. exceed
- C. will exceed
- D. exceeded

22. Should the fiscal deficit _____ the projected ceiling, the central bank will be compelled to hike interest rates.

- A. exceeds
- B. exceeded
- C. will exceed
- D. exceed

22. **Should** the fiscal deficit _____ the projected ceiling, the central bank **will be compelled** to hike interest rates.

- A. exceeds
- B. exceeded
- C. will exceed
- D. exceed**

Explanation: This is an Inverted First Conditional. When starting with "Should," the verb must be in the base form (exceed), not the third-person singular (exceeds). It replaces: "If the fiscal deficit should exceed..."

Simple Example: Should it rain (If it rains), we will stay home.

23. If the protagonist had not survived the shipwreck in the first chapter, the novel _____ so popular among contemporary readers now.

A. wouldn't have been

B. wouldn't be

C. isn't

D. won't be

23. If the protagonist had not survived the shipwreck in the first chapter, the novel _____ so popular among contemporary readers now.

A. wouldn't have been

B. won't be

C. isn't

D. wouldn't be

23. If the protagonist **had not survived** the shipwreck in the first chapter, the novel _____ so popular among contemporary readers **now**.

A. wouldn't have been

B. won't be

C. isn't

D. wouldn't be

Explanation: Mixed Type (3 + 2). A past event (surviving) has a present result (being popular). We use If + Past Perfect with would + V1.

Simple Example: If I had won the lottery (past), I would be rich (now).

24. If the Earth _____ its axial tilt, the seasonal variations we currently experience would cease to exist.

A. loses

B. lost

C. had lost

D. would lose

24. If the Earth _____ its axial tilt, the seasonal variations we currently experience would cease to exist.

A. loses

B. lost

C. had lost

D. would lose

24. If the Earth _____ its axial tilt, the seasonal variations we currently experience **would cease** to exist.

A. loses

B. lost

C. had lost

D. would lose

Explanation: This is a classic Second Conditional expressing a "contrary-to-fact" present hypothesis. We use the Simple Past (lost) in the if-clause and would + V1 in the result clause.

Simple Example: If I had wings (but I don't), I would fly.

25. Had the jury been privy to the suppressed evidence, the verdict _____ fundamentally different.

- A. would be
- B. would have been
- C. had been
- D. will have been

25. Had the jury been privy to the suppressed evidence, the verdict _____ fundamentally different.

A. would have been

B. would be

C. had been

D. will have been

25. **Had** the jury **been** privy to the suppressed evidence, the verdict _____ fundamentally different.

A. **would have been**

B. would be

C. had been

D. will have been

Explanation: An Inverted Third Conditional. It describes a **past** hypothetical situation. The structure is Had + Subject + V3 in the if-clause, requiring would have + V3 in the result clause.

Simple Example: Had I studied (If I had studied), I would have passed.

25. **Had** the jury **been** privy to the suppressed evidence, the verdict _____ fundamentally different.

A. **would have been**

B. would be

C. had been

D. will have been

Explanation: An Inverted Third Conditional. It describes a **past** hypothetical situation. The structure is Had + Subject + V3 in the if-clause, requiring would have + V3 in the result clause.

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